

EVENTWEB: A UNIFIED CAMPUS EVENT DISCOVERY, GIS MAPPING, AND TICKETING SYSTEM FOR KNUST

Technical Report and Architectural Specification
Presented to the Department of Computer Engineering

Author / Candidate: Project Engineering Team

Target Institution: KNUST, Kumasi, Ghana

Academic Term: 2025 / 2026 Academic Year

Core Technologies: HTML5, CSS3, Supabase, Resend

1. Introduction and Background

At Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST), campus life is driven by an active student body and numerous faculty associations organizing hundreds of extracurricular, academic, professional, and social events each semester. These range from engineering conferences, academic symposiums, and software hackathons to society masked dinners, sports tournaments, night markets, and religious fellowships.

Despite the high volume of high-impact campus events, publicity and registration mechanisms across the university remain heavily fragmented. Organizers rely on physical paper flyers pasted over public notice boards, unindexed broadcast messages on WhatsApp group chats, and short-lived social media stories. This lack of a structured digital channel leads to high information decay, poor attendance estimation, venue confusion among freshmen and non-resident students, and severe logistical bottlenecks during door check-ins.

2. Problem Statement and Objectives

The primary challenge addressed by this project is the absence of a reliable, centralized, and spatially aware event coordination platform for the university. Specific issues include:

- **Information Scattering:** Students frequently miss relevant developmental programs due to uncoordinated publicity channels.
- **Geospatial Ambiguity:** Navigating diverse venue locations across campus—such as the Great Hall, Paa Joe Stadium, College of Science Auditorium, and Prempeh II Library—is challenging without integrated maps.
- **Capacity and Roster Bottlenecks:** Student societies lack real-time registration caps and verified attendee rosters, causing hall overcrowding or unexpected empty seats.

The primary objective of EVENTWEB is to design and implement an institutional-grade platform that unifies event discovery, provides spatial navigation on an interactive campus map, automates ticket reservation with unique verification codes, and provides verified societies with an administrative management dashboard.

3. System Architecture and Methodology

EVENTWEB is engineered following a decoupled, three-tier cloud software architecture consisting of a high-performance client frontend, a managed relational database layer, and a serverless notification engine.

- **Presentation Layer (Frontend):** Built using semantic HTML5, custom Modernist CSS tokens, and declarative component state logic. It features zero border-radius styling, precise 1px hairlines, an automated 5-second hero poster carousel with interaction-pause mechanics, and a Leaflet.js campus map.

- **Data and Authentication Layer (Supabase):** Utilizes a managed PostgreSQL 15 database enforcing relational integrity, custom category ENUMs, JSONB attendance tiers, database trigger functions, and Row-Level Security (RLS) policies.
- **Communication Layer (Resend & Edge Functions):** Serverless Deno functions triggered by database insertion webhooks to dispatch branded HTML ticket confirmations and calendar notices.

4. Technical Stack Justification

Component	Technology	Technical Justification
Frontend UI	Semantic HTML5 & Vanilla JS	Eliminates heavy framework bundle overhead; provides sub-second first contentful paint.
Design System	Modernist CSS (1px rules)	Zero border-radius, clean hairline rules, and full WCAG AA contrast compliance.
Spatial GIS	Leaflet.js + OSM Cartography	Lightweight client-side map rendering with accurate KNUST campus venue coordinates.
Relational Database	Supabase (PostgreSQL 15)	ACID transaction guarantees, atomic capacity triggers, and native Row-Level Security.
Authentication	Supabase Auth (JWT)	Role-based separation between public student attendees and verified society organizers.
Object Storage	Supabase Storage (`event-posters`)	CDN-backed image storage with secure authenticated write permissions.
Email Dispatch	Resend API + Edge Functions	Serverless execution ensuring high deliverability without exposing private keys.

5. Relational Database Design and Data Integrity

The relational database schema is normalized across three core tables to guarantee referential integrity and eliminate redundancy:

- **Organizers Table (`organizers`):** Stores society and faculty organizer profiles linked directly to Supabase Auth (`auth.users.id`). Fields include `org\_name`, `org\_type` (Society, Faculty, Club, Committee), `email`, and `is\_verified`.
- **Events Table (`events`):** Stores comprehensive event metadata including title, category ENUM (Academic, Social, Sports, Religious, Business), venue name, date, time, total capacity, registered count, poster image URL, and JSONB attendance options.
- **Registrations Table (`registrations`):** Records individual student ticket reservations. Each row contains a foreign key reference to `events.id`, an optional reference to `user\_id`, a unique door check-in reference code (`EW-XXXX-XX`), the selected tier name, and reminder opt-in status.

5.1 Atomic Concurrency Trigger for Capacity Management

A critical vulnerability in event registration web applications is the race condition, where simultaneous attendee requests can lead to overbooking beyond hall limits. To prevent this, EVENTWEB implements an atomic PostgreSQL trigger function executing at the database level:

```
CREATE OR REPLACE FUNCTION public.handle_new_registration()  
RETURNS trigger AS $$  
BEGIN  
UPDATE public.events SET reg_count = reg_count + 1 WHERE id = new.event_id;  
RETURN new;  
END;  
$$ LANGUAGE plpgsql SECURITY DEFINER;  
  
CREATE TRIGGER on_registration_created  
AFTER INSERT ON public.registrations  
FOR EACH ROW EXECUTE PROCEDURE public.handle_new_registration();
```

5.2 Security and Row-Level Policies (RLS)

Row-Level Security is strictly enabled on all tables. Public anonymous users have `SELECT` access only to published events and `INSERT` permissions to register. Organizers are restricted via `auth.uid() = organizer\_id` so that they can only modify or view attendance logs for events they have published.

6. Geospatial Mapping and Campus Venue Coordinates

To assist students in locating event venues across KNUST, EVENTWEB integrates a dedicated Leaflet GIS module mapped to calibrated campus coordinates:

- **Great Hall:** 6.67475° N, -1.57220° W (Main Ceremonial Hall and Matriculation/Congregation Auditorium)
- **Paa Joe Stadium:** 6.67780° N, -1.56950° W (University Sports Grounds, Marathon Starts, Outdoor Fairs)
- **College of Science Auditorium:** 6.67350° N, -1.56650° W (Academic Conferences, STEM Competitions)
- **Prempeh II Library:** 6.67510° N, -1.57180° W (Central Academic Resource and Seminar Rooms)

- **KNUST Interdenominational Church:** 6.68508° N, -1.57270° W (Religious Fellowships and Services)
- **Central Campus / Brunei Complex:** 6.67644° N, -1.57343° W (Night Markets, Fusion Festivals)

The mapping layer uses architectural drafting pins with category-coded color indicators. Selecting an event in the list smoothly pans the map viewport to that venue, while tapping a map marker instantly filters the event roster.

7. User Interface and Interaction Engineering

- **5-Second Autoplay Rotation:** The homepage poster showcase automatically advances to the next flyer every 5000 milliseconds when idle. When the user manually clicks next/previous controls, carousel indicators, or drags a card, the timer resets and restarts a fresh 5-second countdown from that moment.
- **Thin 1px Modernist Hairlines:** All interface components (cards, navbar, search input, chips, and modal sheets) utilize a clean 1px hairline rule (`--ew-rule: 1px`). In dark mode, borders shift to `#29324a` to seamlessly blend without harsh glare.
- **Modal Focus Isolation:** Opening an event registration sheet automatically suspends background rotations to preserve user concentration while filling out details.

8. Transactional Pass and Reminder Pipeline (Resend)

When a student registers, Supabase triggers a serverless Edge Function running on the Deno runtime. This function calls the Resend REST API to dispatch an immediate confirmation pass containing the event title, flyer thumbnail, society name, date, venue, and unique entry verification code (`EW-XXXX-XX`). API keys are securely stored in server environment variables and never exposed to client browsers.

9. Conclusion and Academic Defense Summary

EVENTWEB successfully demonstrates how modern web engineering, geospatial cartography, and cloud database architectures can solve a tangible logistical challenge in tertiary education. By replacing fragmented publicity channels with a unified, aesthetically refined platform, EVENTWEB provides KNUST students and student societies with a dependable, scalable, and high-performance event coordination infrastructure.